A fearless trailblazer

From 1903–04, a time when Indian women were largely relegated to domestic roles and rarely seen in public, Sarojini began to involve herself in politics. Her ability to craft powerful speeches and speak fluently and persuasively made her stand out. She often spoke about the need for unity beyond caste and religion, as well as on the necessity of equal rights for women. She soon grew to be one of the most visible and well-respected members of the Congress (she was the first Indian woman to be elected the party's president in 1925), was a co-founder of the Women's Indian Association (WIA) and a member of the Constituent Assembly.

IDEAS OF INDIA

These three writers were born in colonial India, but their lives also spanned the struggle for freedom and the years after Independence. In strikingly different ways, each of them wrote stories that explore life in modern India in all its confusing, funny, sad and beautiful complexity.

RASIPURAM KRISHNASWAMI NARAYAN

1906–2001